



YOU ARE **24 WEEKS AND 2 DAYS**

110 days to go...

YOUR BABY TODAY

In the uterus, your baby's ears have fluid around them and also inside. This is part of the reason that they can hear only certain lower sound frequencies. Yawning may be a way to unblock the ears, and from now on your baby spends a lot of time yawning.

“If you're feeling tired, you're not alone. Your developing baby has been yawning for some weeks now.”

All babies are known to yawn in the uterus, although the reason why they do this remains unclear. Yawning is often accompanied by shrugging of the shoulders or stretching, exactly as you would do when tired. Unborn babies have even been seen to rub their eyes!

Your baby first started yawning at around 15 weeks and has gradually yawned more and more frequently. The precise function of yawning for the baby remains in doubt and there are several hypotheses. While it's difficult to imagine that an unborn baby is actually tired, it has been found that babies who are anemic yawn much more frequently than others. Another theory is that yawning may help the unborn baby to regulate the amount of fluid or blood flow they have within their lungs. Or when the baby yawns, it may simply be a primitive reflex.

Whatever the reason for yawning, the early stage at which this develops, and the fact that all mammals are known to yawn in the uterus suggests that it plays an important, though unknown, role in fetal development.